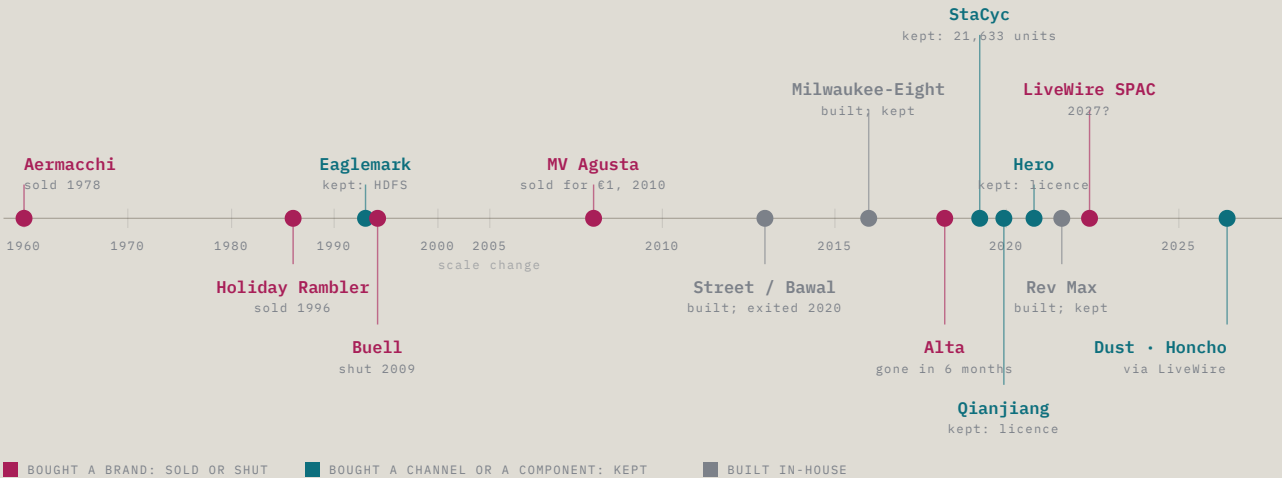


GROUND TRUTH NO. 03 · HARLEY-DAVIDSON, INC. · SEPTEMBER 2026

HARLEY-DAVIDSON: OUTSIDE IN

SIXTY-SIX YEARS OF BUYING WHAT IT COULD BUILD

WHAT HARLEY-DAVIDSON REACHED OUTSIDE FOR, 1960-2026



HARLEY-DAVIDSON DOESN'T WANT ELECTRIC. IT WANTS FLOOR TRAFFIC.

WHAT THEY SAID May 2026, the new plan: “leveraging existing powertrain, existing platforms” and “executing better with the platforms we already have rather than introducing entirely new ones.” The first new bike is the Sprint, on a **440cc** single Hero MotoCorp builds in Rajasthan.

WHAT IT IS The sixty-sixth year of the same move. Every brand Harley ever bought was sold or shut, with the same sentence. MV Agusta: **\$105.1M** in, **\$268.4M** lost, sold

back for **€1**. Alta: a stake too small to disclose, gone in six months. StaCyc: **\$14.9M**, and it outsells LiveWire **33 to 1**.

WHAT DECIDED IT

Harley builds when the product carries the full brand at the full price. Everything below the big twin (a small bike, a balance bike, a battery, a loan book) gets bought, licensed or partnered. It stays when it feeds the dealer. It goes when it competes with the badge.

HARLEY DOESN'T WANT ELECTRIC. IT WANTS FLOOR TRAFFIC.

SOURCES: HOG FORMS 10-K (FY1994, FY1996, FY2009, FY2010, FY2011, FY2018, FY2019, FY2020, FY2025) · 10-Q (Q3 2008, Q3 2009, Q1 2018, Q3 2018, Q1 2019) · 8-K (11 JUL 2008, 15 OCT 2009, 9 AUG 2010 INCL. EX. 2.1, 24 SEP 2020, 13 DEC 2021) · FASTER FASTER, INC. FORMS D (2016-2018) · LVWR 8-K (30 SEP 2022; 22 MAY 2026) AND 10-K (FY2022) · LIVEWIRE FY2025 AND Q2 2026 RESULTS · HERO MOTOCORP X440 RELEASE (3 JUL 2023) · H-D CALL TRANSCRIPTS Q1 2019, Q3 2021, Q2 2025, Q1 2026, Q2 2026

MV AGUSTA · LOSS FROM DISCONTINUED OPS, 2008-10

\$268.4M

On \$105.1M of consideration. Sold back for €1 with €20M of Harley cash inside.

ALTA MOTORS · AMOUNT INVESTED, PER EVERY H-D FILING

Not stated

Bounded by Alta's Form D: at most \$5.65M. Out in six months.

STACYC · TOTAL CONSIDERATION, Q1 2019 10-Q

\$14.9M

\$7.0M cash, a \$6.5M earn-out paid in full. Every volume target hit.

STACYCS PER LIVEWIRE MOTORCYCLE, 2025

33 : 1

21,633 balance bikes. 653 motorcycles. 76% of LiveWire's product revenue.

FOUR NUMBERS FROM THE FILINGS. THE REST OF THE RECORD IS IN §01.

THE ROUTE · SIX PARTS, ONE THESIS

PART I

THE RECORD

Sixteen moves in one table. Brands go. Channels and components stay.

PART II

SAME SENTENCE

→ Buell and MV Agusta. \$125M and \$268M. "Focus on the Harley-Davidson brand."

PART III

TOO SMALL TO SAY

→ Alta, never disclosed. StaCyc, \$14.9M, and it outsells LiveWire 33 to 1.

PART IV

WHAT IT BUILDS

PART V

THE SPRINT RHYME

PART VI

THE FINAL WORD

Two engines kept. One small bike lost money and left. The rule.

→ 1960: an Aermacchi. 2026: a Hero. Same hole, somebody else's engine.

→ Seven CEOs, one cycle. LiveWire is on the Buell script. What it was for.

00 • START HERE

THE FINDING, AND THE TRAIL THAT LED TO IT

Harley-Davidson has spent sixty-six years buying, licensing and partnering its way into every segment below the big twin, and building from within only when the product carries the full brand at the full price. Here is how three old filings led me to that sentence.

Start with what they said. May 5, 2026, the Q1 call, the new CEO explaining the plan: “By using and leveraging existing powertrain, existing platforms, we can have a much broader assortment of motorcycles to present.” The first new motorcycle under that plan is the Sprint. Its engine is a **440cc** single that Hero MotoCorp co-developed with Harley and builds in Neemrana for the X440, a **₹2.29 lakh** motorcycle, about \$2,760. On the same call: “we’re finalizing the specific production plans.” A company that says it will lean on the platforms it already has is opening the plan with one it does not own.

That sent me back through the record. Not the press record; the filed one. What did Harley pay each time it reached outside the building, what did it get, and how did it end?

- Open the FY2009 and FY2010 10-Ks and MV Agusta is not the “~\$163M” everyone quotes. It is **\$268.4M** of net loss from discontinued operations in twenty-four months, on **\$105.1M** of consideration, **\$20.1M** of which was written off on the day it closed.
- Open the 8-K of August 9, 2010 and the sale agreement is attached. The shares went for **€1**. The U.S. company for **\$1**. A **€103.8M** receivable for another euro. Harley put **€20.0M** into escrow on the way out.

- Search every 10-Q and 10-K Harley filed in 2018 and 2019 for “Alta.” One hit, one sentence, in a press release. No amount. Alta’s own Form D chain bounds it at **\$5.65M**.
- Open the Q1 2019 10-Q and StaCyc cost **\$14.9M**. LiveWire’s carve-out statements show the earn-out was paid in full. In 2025 it sold **21,633** units to LiveWire’s **653**.
- Line them up by what each one was for and the pattern writes itself: the finance company and the balance bikes were bought to feed the dealer, and they stayed. The brands were bought to be a second Harley, and they went.

None of this is secret. All of it is in the exhibits, and most of it has not been read in a decade.

THE TRAIL, IN FIVE DOCUMENTS

The order I read them in. Each one sent me to the next.

01

[Q1 2026 EARNINGS CALL • 5 MAY 2026 →](#)

“Existing platforms.” Starrs on the plan, and on the Sprint: “we’re finalizing the specific production plans.” The engine is Hero’s. Why does a company with the Milwaukee-Eight not build a 440?

02

[FORM 10-K FY2009 • MV AGUSTA NOTE →](#)

\$115.4M. The impairment, fourteen months after closing. Consideration €68.3M, goodwill \$85.8M, IPR&D of \$20.1M written off at once. The Buell decision, taken the same week, is in the 10-Q beside it.

03

[SALE AND PURCHASE AGREEMENT • EX. 2.1 TO 8-K, 9 AUG 2010 →](#)

€1. §2.1.1(a): the MV Agusta shares “for a consideration of Euro 1 (one).” §7.1.1: a capital increase of €20,000,000. §7.2.2(a): the earn-out “finally and irrevocably waived.” The 10-K says “nominal consideration.” This is what nominal means.

04

[FASTER FASTER, INC. • FORM D/A • 5 FEB 2018 →](#)

\$20,843,998. Alta’s round, closed by amendment four weeks before Harley’s announcement. Six investors and \$5.65M added since July. Harley’s own filings never give a number; this is the ceiling.

05

FORM 10-Q Q1 2019 • GOODWILL NOTE →

\$14.9 million. StaCyc: \$7.0M of cash, \$9.5M of goodwill, and a stated reason: “building the next generation of riders.” Then LiveWire’s FY2025 release: 21,633 of them, against 653 motorcycles.

FOUR INSTRUMENTS

The paperwork that decided each ending.

MV AGUSTA • SALE

€1, €1, AND \$1

Three nominal payments, €20M of operating capital contributed, the 2016 earn-out waived. Eleven days of drafting between the board’s July 31 signature and the August 6 close. Harley received “nominal consideration” and reported “an immaterial loss on the date of sale.”

31 Jul 2010 • closed 6 Aug 2010 • Ex. 2.1

BUELL • 10-Q NOTE

\$125M, ESTIMATED

Board approval 14 Oct 2009; production ended that month. ~\$70M in incentives, inventory and operating costs, ~\$14M of fixed assets, ~\$9M of severance, ~\$32M of contracts. The realized total was never broken out again.

Q3 2009 10-Q • Note 19

ALTA • FORM D CHAIN

FIVE NOTICES, NO HARLEY

Alta’s legal name. Five Reg D notices from 2016 to 2018. The equity round closed 2 Feb 2018 at \$20.84M. A \$5.0M bridge note started selling 27 Jul 2018; \$2.45M placed with four investors. Harley’s exit leaked sixteen days later.

Mar 2016 – Aug 2018 • CIK 1620298

DUST • ASSET PURCHASE

\$375,000 CASH

Plus \$500K of stock, three annual \$875K stock installments, and earn-outs up to \$11.25M in stock. The Alta structure, done inside LiveWire this time, where a write-off lands in a segment the parent has already told investors to look past.

- **Why.** Back to the Bricks is scored on HDMC alone and opens with a licensee’s motorcycle. Whether the Sprint and the 883 get built in Harley’s own plants, at a price where Harley makes money, is the whole test of the plan. The record says what usually happens.
- **Who for.** Anyone deciding whether the Sprint is a product or a channel program; anyone holding HOG into a 2027 that contains the 883, a Sprint, and a LiveWire decision; and the people at Juneau Avenue who already know this and cannot say it.
- **What I did.** Read the acquisition, impairment and discontinued-operations notes for every outside move since 1993, the sale agreement for MV, Alta’s Form D chain, and LiveWire’s carve-out statements for StaCyc. Derived figures are arithmetic on filed numbers, shown in the captions. Secondary sources are used only where flagged.
- **Who I am.** I ran product at Harley-Davidson: Touring, CVO, Trike. I have sat in the meeting where a small-bike program gets its cost target. §13.

PART I PART II PART III PART IV PART V PART VI

HARLEY-DAVIDSON, INC. · NYSE: HOG

PART I

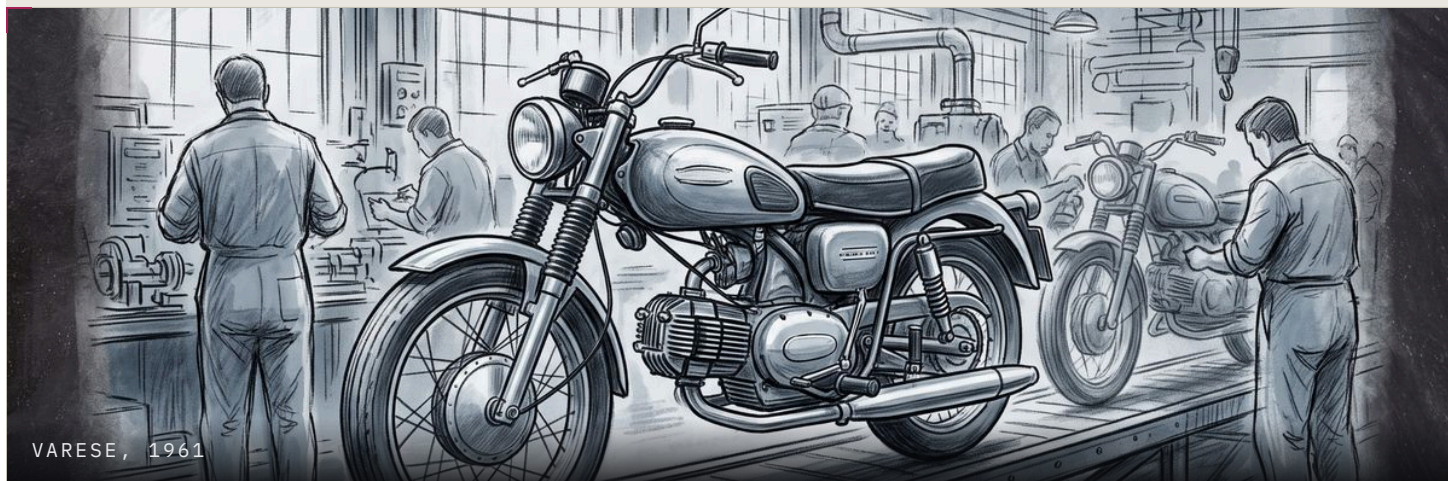
THE RECORD

Every time Harley-Davidson reached outside the building, 1960 to 2026, from the filings.

THE POINT

Sixteen moves. Every purchased brand is gone. Every purchased channel or component is still here: the finance company, the balance bikes, the licences, the assembly lines.

The pattern is the argument. Once you see what stayed and what went, the Sprint, the 883 and LiveWire stop being three decisions and become one.



01 • THE RECORD

HARLEY-DAVIDSON, INC. • NYSE: HOG

SIXTEEN MOVES, ONE TABLE

Every figure is from a filing or a company release unless marked ~, which means a secondary source and an open item. “n/d” means the company never disclosed it. Read the last column first.

YEAR	MOVE	IN / OUT	COST, AS FILED	HOW IT ENDED
1960	50% of Aermacchi's motorcycle division, Varese	Out	~\$250K	The original Harley-Davidson Sprint , 250/350 singles. Full ownership early 1970s. Sold to the Castiglioni (Cagiva) 1978
1986	Holiday Rambler, recreational vehicles	Out	~\$155M	Segment sold 1996, ~\$105M, gain \$22.6M, "in order to concentrate on its core motorcycle business"
1993	49% of Eaglemark Financial Services; the rest Nov 1995	Out	\$10M + ~\$45M	Became HDFS . \$248M of operating income in 2024. 9.8% sold to KKR/PIMCO at ~1.75× book, 2025
1993	49% of Buell; substantially all of the rest Feb 1998	Out	~\$500K; 1998 n/d	Shut Oct 2009. Announced exit cost ~\$125M . "Focus both our effort and our investment on the Harley-Davidson brand"
2008	MV Agusta + Cagiva	Out	€68.3M (\$105.1M)	Sold back to Castiglioni 6 Aug 2010 for €1 + \$1 + €1, with €20.0M of H-D cash contributed. Net loss from discontinued ops \$268.4M in 24 months
2013	Street 500/750, Revolution X, Bawal (India)	In	n/d	"First all-new platform in 13 years." India manufacturing exited Sept 2020, ~\$75M restructuring. "Unprofitable," per the CFO, Q3 2021
2016	Milwaukee-Eight	In	n/d	Still the Big Twin
2017	Rayong, Thailand plant	In, offshore	n/d	Rev Max models for the U.S. moved there 2024; returning to York and Menomonee Falls before 2027

YEAR	MOVE	IN / OUT	COST, AS FILED	HOW IT ENDED
2018	Equity in Alta Motors (Faster Faster, Inc.) + co-development	Out	never stated	H-D out by August; Alta closed 17 Oct 2018; BRP bought the IP. H-D's own Silicon Valley EV R&D facility announced 5 Sep 2018
2019	StaCyc, Inc.	Out	\$14.9M	LiveWire's only profitable unit. 21,633 units in 2025
2019	Qianjiang (Geely), 338cc for China	Out, licence	n/d	X350/X500 in Asia. The X350RA is the U.S. Riding Academy bike, not for sale
2020	Hero MotoCorp, India distribution and brand licence	Out, licence	follows ~\$75M exit	X440 launched Jul 2023, Hero-built, ₹2.29 lakh (about \$2,760). The Sprint's engine
2021	Revolution Max / Pan America	In	n/d	Pan America, Sportster S, Nightster. Thailand 2024–26; coming home
2021	LiveWire SPAC; KYMCO \$100M	Out, capital	H-D \$100M; \$1.77B EV	923 units TTM; \$422M of consolidated losses (No. 02)
2025	HDFS: 4.9% each to KKR and PIMCO; >\$5B of receivables; two-thirds forward flow	Out, capital	~\$1.25B in	HDFS operating income guided from \$490M to \$55–70M (No. 02 \$2)
2026	Dust Motorcycles, Inc., via LiveWire	Out	\$375K cash + stock	Pre-revenue; product “2H 2026”; earn-outs to \$11.25M
2026	S4 Honcho, produced by KYMCO	Out, contract mfg	\$4,999 / \$5,499	KYMCO exclusive for five years on the maxi-scooter and “any future products on which the parties may agree”

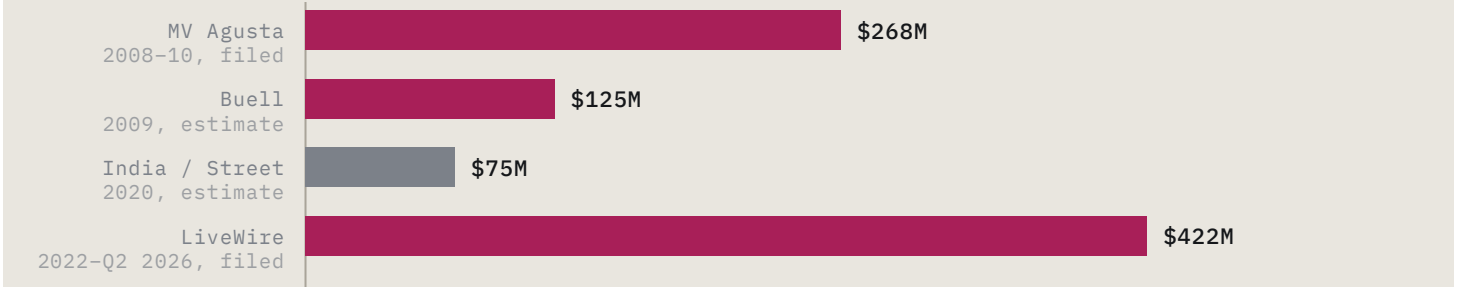
YEAR	MOVE	IN / OUT	COST, AS FILED	HOW IT ENDED
2026–27	Sprint (Hero 440 single); Sportster 883	In?		Sprint production “being finalized”; sub-\$6,000 (Jul 2025) now “less than \$10,000” (trade). The 883: first air-cooled twin program since the Evolution

Two patterns fall out before any analysis. Every outside purchase that carried its own brand was sold or shut: Holiday Rambler, Buell, MV Agusta, Aermacchi. Three of the four went within two years of a CEO change, with the same sentence. Every outside move that carried no badge into a Harley segment has been kept, quietly: Eaglemark’s balance sheet, StaCyc’s balance bikes, Hero’s engine, Qianjiang’s twin, KYMCO’s assembly line, KKR’s capital. They feed the dealer without competing with the Harley-Davidson brand.

FIG 01

WHAT THE OUTSIDE MOVES COST TO UNWIND

\$ MILLIONS · FILED WHERE AVAILABLE



CALCULATED

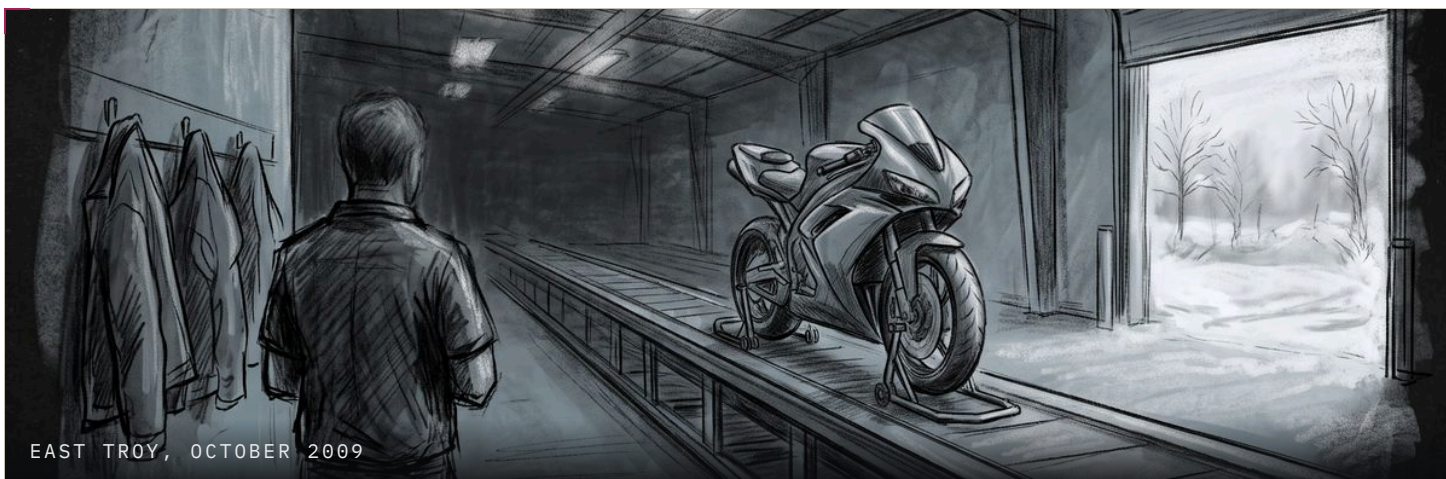
MV Agusta is the filed net loss from discontinued operations, 2008–2010. Buell and India are the company’s announced estimates; neither was ever reconciled in a later filing. LiveWire is the consolidated operating loss from the spin through Q2 2026, from No. 02. Alta is missing from this chart because there is no number to put on it.

THE POINT	Harley-Davidson has gone outside for a product sixteen times in sixty-six years. The brands are gone. The channels and components stayed.
BACK TO THE THESIS	What survives a CEO change at Harley is whatever makes money on somebody else's product on a Harley dealer's floor.
OUTLOOK	The Sprint is a Hero engine, the Honcho is a KYMCO build, Dust is an option. Read the table and you know which column each is in.

SAME SENTENCE

Buell and MV Agusta: what the two biggest purchases cost, and the words used both times.

THE POINT	Buell: ~\$125M to shut, sixteen years after the first stake. MV Agusta: \$105.1M in, \$268.4M of losses in twenty-four months, sold back for a euro with €20M of Harley cash inside.
WHY IT MATTERS	1996: “concentrate on its core motorcycle business.” 2009 and 2010: “focus ... on the Harley-Davidson brand.” The words repeat because the decision does: a second brand that competes with Harley-Davidson for engineering dollars does not survive the next CEO.



02 • BUELL

HARLEY-DAVIDSON, INC. · NYSE: HOG

SIXTEEN YEARS, ONE PARAGRAPH, \$125 MILLION

Harley took 49% of Buell in 1993 for about half a million dollars, and “substantially all of the remaining shares” in February 1998. Eleven years after that, a new CEO wrote it down in one board meeting.

Buell shipped **13,119** motorcycles in 2008 and **9,572** in 2009, on revenue of **\$123.1M** and **\$46.5M**. The 2009 number is after a Q4 of negative \$4.0M, when dealers returned inventory. On October 14, 2009 the board “committed to the discontinuation of its Buell product line.” The subsequent-events note in the Q3 2009 10-Q put the cost at approximately **\$125 million**: \$115M in 2009 and \$10M in 2010; sales incentives, inventory write-downs and operating costs ~\$70M; fixed-asset impairments ~\$14M; one-time termination benefits ~\$9M; contractual obligations ~\$32M; about 60% of it cash. Roughly 80 hourly and 100 salaried positions, employment ending December 18.

“The fact is we must focus both our effort and our investment on the Harley-Davidson brand, as we believe this provides an optimal path to sustained, meaningful, long-term growth.”

“We believe we can create a bright long-term future for our stakeholders through a single-minded focus on the Harley-Davidson brand.”

“Buell and MV Agusta are great companies, with proud brands, high-quality exciting products and passionate enthusiasm for the motorcycle business.” 8-K Ex. 99.1, 15 Oct 2009

The realized Buell cost was never reported on its own. It went into the 2009 restructuring plan, which expensed **\$220.9M** in 2009 and **\$119.1M** in 2010, and the FY2010 10-K closes the file in one sentence: “The Company ceased production of Buell motorcycles at the end of October 2009.” Buell’s own statement said it had built “more than 135,000 motorcycles” since 1983. Erik Buell, eighteen months later: “They didn’t shut down Buell because they were mean.” He was right. They shut it because it was a second brand in a building that has room for one.

■ SO WHAT · §02

THE POINT

Buell cost about \$125M to close and was never reconciled. It was the first purchased brand a new CEO killed inside a year.

BACK TO THE THESIS

The sentence Wandell used is the one the company has used for every brand exit since 1996. It is not a Buell sentence. It is a Harley sentence.

OUTLOOK

LiveWire has a new CEO who did not start it, and the sentence has already been said: “we leaned heavily into Touring and Electric.”

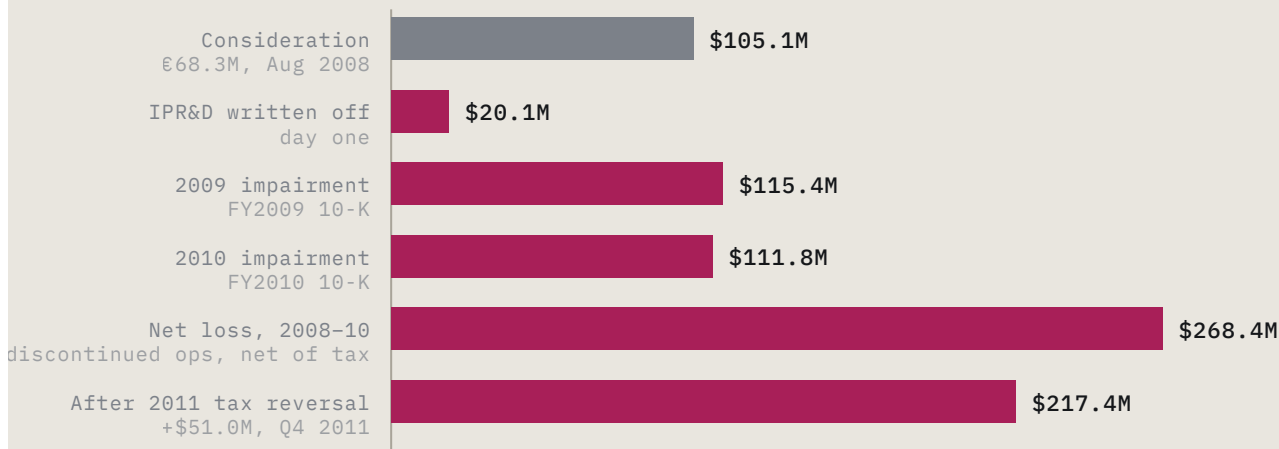
\$105 MILLION IN. \$268 MILLION OUT. SOLD FOR A EURO.

Announced July 11, 2008 under Jim Ziemer, closed August 8, committed for sale October 2009, gone August 6, 2010. The whole thing fits inside one Harley-Davidson CEO transition, and the filings record every dollar of it.

The announcement: “total consideration of approximately 70 million euros (\$109 million), which includes the satisfaction of existing bank debt for approximately 45 million euros (\$70 million),” plus a contingent payment to Claudio Castiglioni in 2016. Ziemer: “Motorcycles are the heart, soul and passion of Harley-Davidson, Buell and MV Agusta.” The final allocation in the FY2009 10-K: consideration **€68.3M (\$105.1M)**, of which €47.5M (\$73.2M) retired bank debt; net assets acquired **\$95.6M**; goodwill **\$85.8M**; intangibles \$52.8M, of which **\$20.1M** was in-process research and development “written off subsequent to the acquisition.” A fifth of the purchase price, expensed on arrival.

FIG 02 MV AGUSTA: WHAT WENT IN, WHAT WAS WRITTEN OFF, WHAT WAS LOST

\$ MILLIONS · FY2009, FY2010 AND FY2011 10-KS



CALCULATED The first bar is what Harley paid. The next three are the filed write-offs: \$20.1M of IPR&D on arrival; \$115.4M in 2009 (goodwill \$85.5M, fixed assets \$19.8M, intangibles \$10.1M); \$111.8M in 2010 (receivables \$32.3M, inventory \$25.2M, fixed assets \$26.9M, intangibles \$15.8M, other). The last two are the filed net loss from discontinued operations (\$29.5M + \$125.8M + \$113.1M = \$268.4M) and the same figure after the \$51.0M tax-reserve reversal of Q4 2011. Impairments alone were \$227.2M pre-tax, more than double the purchase price.

DISCONTINUED OPERATIONS, AS FILED	REVENUE	LOSS BEFORE TAX	NET LOSS
2008 (8 Aug – 31 Dec)	\$15.9M	\$(31.9)M	\$(29.5)M
2009	\$56.7M	\$(165.4)M	\$(125.8)M
2010 (to 6 Aug)	\$48.6M	\$(131.0)M	\$(113.1)M
Total, 24 months	\$121.2M	\$(328.4)M	\$(268.4)M
2011: tax reserves reversed on IRS agreement		\$(0.4)M	+\$51.0M
Net			\$(217.4)M

On \$105.1M of consideration that is **2.55 times** the purchase price lost, or **\$11.2M** a month for every month Harley owned the company. The impairments

alone, \$115.4M in 2009 and \$111.8M in 2010, come to **\$227.2M** pre-tax. More than double what was paid.

THE SALE, AND THE €1 / €2 / €3 QUESTION

The FY2010 10-K says only that “the Company received nominal consideration in return for the transfer of MV and related assets.” The Sale and Purchase Agreement, filed as Exhibit 2.1 to the 8-K of August 9, 2010, is where the number lives.

DOCUMENTED THE SHARES	§2.1.1(a): H-D Varese Holding transfers “all rights, title and interest ... in the MV Agusta Shares” (all 120,000 ordinary shares, the entire capital of MV Agusta Motor S.p.A.) “for a consideration of Euro 1 (one).”
DOCUMENTED THE U.S. COMPANY	The membership interests in MV Agusta USA LLC, for US\$1.
DOCUMENTED THE RECEIVABLE	An intercompany receivable of €103,789,617.60, the money Harley had lent its own subsidiary, for €1.
DOCUMENTED THE CASH LEFT INSIDE	§7.1.1: a capital increase of “Euro 20,000,000 (twenty million)” less sums already received, paid into escrow. The 8-K: “the Company contributed 20 million Euros to MV as operating capital.”
DOCUMENTED THE EARN-OUT	§7.2.2(a): Castiglioni’s right to the 2016 earn-out “will be finally and irrevocably waived and dismissed with prejudice.”
CALCULATED THEREFORE	“€1” is the share price. “€3” is the press adding the three nominal payments. “€2” counts only the euros. All three are right. The 10-K’s “immaterial loss on the date of sale” is also right: by August 2010 there was nothing left to lose.

“Our decision to divest MV Agusta reflects our strategy to focus our efforts and our investment on the Harley-Davidson brand, as we believe this provides an optimal path to long-term growth.”

IN 1996 THE SENTENCE WAS
“CORE MOTORCYCLE BUSINESS.”
IN 2009 AND 2010 IT WAS “THE
HARLEY-DAVIDSON BRAND.” THE
WORDS REPEAT BECAUSE THE
DECISION DOES.

■ SO WHAT · §03

THE POINT

MV Agusta cost \$105.1M and lost \$268.4M in twenty-four months. It went back to the seller for three nominal payments and €20M of Harley cash.

BACK TO THE THESIS

It is the one time Harley bought big, and it is the reason every outside move since has been sized to be forgettable.

OUTLOOK

The Castiglioni's got the factory back in 2010 the way they got Aermacchi's in 1978. Harley is now buying a 440 single from Hero. See Part V.

PART I PART II **PART III** PART IV PART V PART VI

HARLEY-DAVIDSON, INC. · NYSE: HOG

PART III

TOO SMALL TO SAY

Alta, which Harley never put a number on, and StaCyc, the one purchase that has hit every target it was given.

THE POINT Alta: one sentence in one press release, no amount in any filing, bounded by Alta's own Form D at \$5.65M, gone in six months. StaCyc: \$14.9M, earn-out paid in full, 21,633 units in 2025 to LiveWire's 653.

WHY IT MATTERS Together they show what Harley actually wanted from electric. Not a motorcycle company. A battery it could learn from, and a \$649 product that puts a family on a dealer floor.



04 • ALTA MOTORS

HARLEY-DAVIDSON, INC. • NYSE: HOG

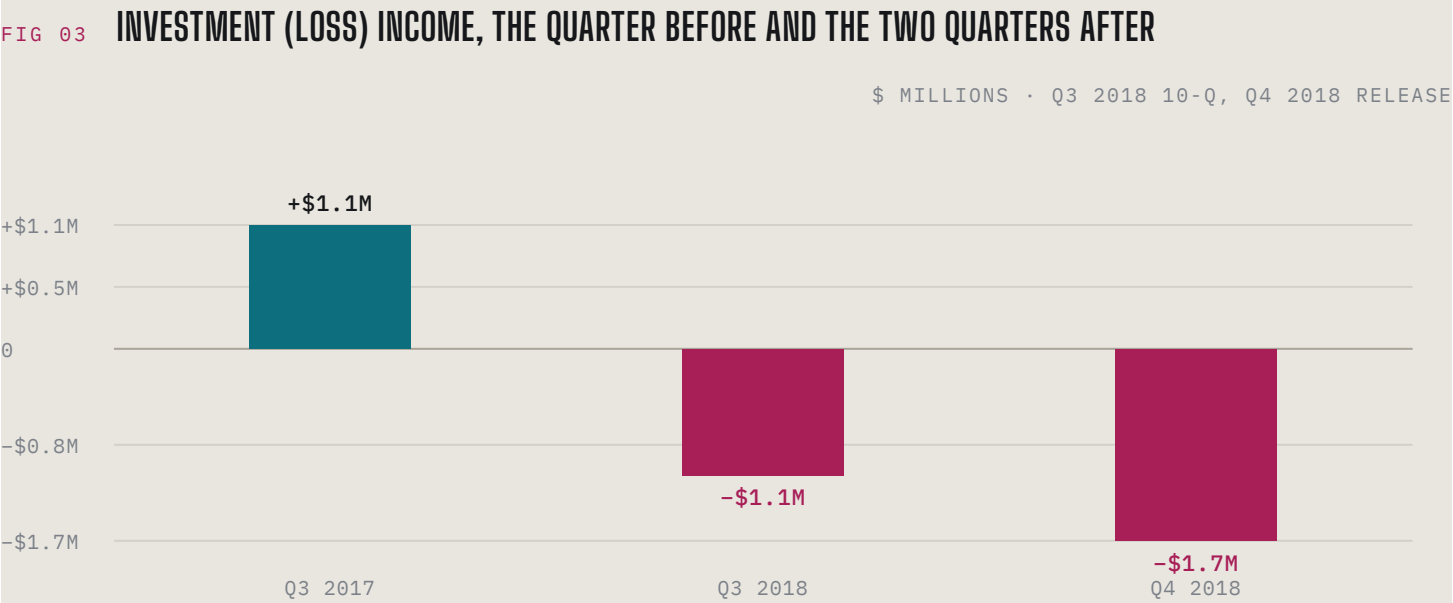
ONE SENTENCE, NO NUMBER, SIX MONTHS

March 1, 2018: “Harley-Davidson Invests In Alta Motors; Companies Will Collaborate On Future Electric Motorcycle Product Development.” Search every filing Harley made in 2018 and 2019 for what it paid, and this is what you find.

Matt Levatich, in the release: “Alta has demonstrated innovation and expertise in EV and their objectives align closely with ours. We each have strengths and capabilities

that will be mutually beneficial as we work together to develop cutting-edge electric motorcycles.” No amount. No percentage. The Q1 2018 earnings release, filed as an 8-K exhibit on April 24, is the only Harley-Davidson SEC filing that has ever contained the word “Alta”: *“Invested in a collaborative agreement with Alta Motors, an innovator in lightweight electric vehicles, supporting Harley-Davidson’s commitment to lead in the electrification of the sport of motorcycling.”*

That is the whole disclosure. A full-text search of every 10-Q and 10-K from April 2018 through December 2019 finds no equity investment, no carrying value, no impairment of an investment, no write-off, no “privately held,” no “readily determinable fair value.” The stake sat below the threshold at which a \$5.7 billion company has to tell anyone what it paid. The only footprint is one line on the income statement.



INFERRED The line ran at roughly +\$1M a quarter and went to -\$1.1M in Q3 2018 and -\$1.7M in Q4 2018; full-year investment income fell from \$3.58M to \$0.95M. No filing attributes the swing, and the FY2018 10-K paragraph that would explain it was not retrieved (open item 1). The inference is mine: this is where a small, un-named equity stake would go when it is written to zero.

ALTA'S OWN PAPERWORK BOUNDS IT

Alta Motors was the trade name. The company was **Faster Faster, Inc.**, Brisbane, California, CIK 1620298, and it filed a Form D for every round it raised.

FILED	OFFERING	SOLD	INVESTORS	SIGNED BY
7 Mar 2016	\$7.0M convertible notes	\$1.77M	18	Marc Fenigstein, CEO
2 Jun 2017	\$26.1M equity (first sale 18 May 2017)	\$12.4M	42	Fenigstein, CEO
3 Jul 2017	\$20.3M equity + debt (first sale 20 Jun 2017)	\$15.2M	24	Derek Dorresteyn, Secretary
5 Feb 2018 (D/A)	Same round, amended and closed: \$20,843,998	\$20.84M	30	Arno Harris, CEO · signed 2 Feb
13 Aug 2018	\$5.0M debt (first sale 27 Jul 2018)	\$2.45M	4	Harris, CEO · signed 10 Aug

The round Harley joined was closed by amendment on February 2, 2018, four weeks before the announcement. Between the July 2017 notice and the February 2018 amendment the round grew by **\$5.65M** and **six** investors. No Form D reports an equity sale after that. If Harley's money is in that round, and there is nowhere else in the record for it to be, the check was inside \$5.65M. **INFERRED** Harley has never stated the figure.

2 FEB 2018	Alta closes its equity round at \$20,843,998 (Form D/A, filed 5 Feb).
1 MAR 2018	Harley announces the investment and co-development. "We intend to be the world leader in the electrification of motorcycles."
30 JUL 2018	"More Roads to Harley-Davidson": LiveWire in 2019, "additional models through 2022," \$450–550M of operating investment. Alta is not mentioned.

27 JUL 2018	Alta begins selling a \$5.0M bridge note; \$2.45M placed with four investors (Form D, filed 13 Aug).
29 AUG 2018	Asphalt & Rubber, sourced: Harley “has all but removed itself from its joint motorcycle project with Alta.” No company statement. UNVERIFIED
5 SEP 2018	Harley announces “a new advanced technology R&D facility in Silicon Valley”: about 25 staff, “battery, power electronics, and e-machine design and development.” Alta’s specialty, one exit away from Alta’s building.
17 OCT 2018	Alta ceases operations. Harley to TechCrunch: “Our collaborative efforts with Alta Motors were productive and we were pleased with the development work we partnered on.”
20 FEB 2019	BRP buys “certain intellectual property, patents and some limited physical assets” and says it has “no interest in restarting operations of Alta Motors.”

UNVERIFIED
THE OTHER SIDE OF THE STORY · ON THE RECORD, UNVERIFIED

Marc Fenigstein, Alta’s co-founder and first CEO, told RideApart in 2024 that the deal was to “split development costs right down the line” on Alta’s second-generation platform, with Alta “effectively ... a supplier of [Harley’s] next platform,” and that when LiveWire’s S2 Del Mar appeared, “our drawings, our engineering CAD and our concept sketches from early 2018” matched it “almost one for one.”

That is his account. It is public, Harley has not answered it, and no filing supports or contradicts it. **Disclosure: I know Marc Fenigstein and have worked with him since Alta closed. The quote is here because it is public and material. Weigh it knowing that.**

THE POINT	Harley paid a sum too small to disclose, learned what it needed about batteries and e-machines, and opened its own lab a week after the split leaked. Six months, one press release, no number.
BACK TO THE THESIS	Alta is the cleanest case in the table: the technology without the partner, at a price that never had to be explained.
OUTLOOK	Dust Motorcycles, May 2026: \$375,000 in cash, the rest in LiveWire stock and earn-outs. The same shape, one level down, where a write-off is already priced in.

\$14.9 MILLION, AND IT OUTSELLS LIVEWIRE 33 TO 1

The Q1 2019 10-Q: “On March 4, 2019, the Company purchased certain assets and liabilities of StaCyc, Inc. for total consideration of \$14.9 million including cash paid at acquisition of \$7.0 million.” The stated reason was not electrification. It was the next customer.

Harley’s filing never explains the other \$7.9M. LiveWire’s carve-out financials, filed when the SPAC closed, do: a contingent earn-out with a fair value of **\$4.98M** at acquisition and a maximum of \$6.537M, paid **\$2.18M** in each of 2020, 2021 and 2022. StaCyc hit every volume target it was given.

STACYC CONSIDERATION		\$	SOURCE: Q1 2019 10-Q; LVWR 8-K 30 SEP 2022; LVWR 10-K FY2022 R71
At acquisition, 4 Mar 2019	\$14.9M	Total consideration; \$7.0M cash; goodwill \$9.5M (tax-deductible); intangibles \$5.3M	
Earn-out, fair value at close	\$4.98M	Maximum \$6.537M, “based on the achievement of sales volume targets” over three twelve-month periods from June 2019	
Paid 2020	\$2.18M	First performance period met	
Paid 2021	\$2.18M	Second period met	
Paid 24 Jun 2022	\$2.18M	“the final earnout payment.” Third period met	
Total paid	\$6.54M	Effectively the maximum. Every volume milestone hit	

DOCUMENTED WHAT IT WAS BOUGHT FOR · THEIR WORDS

Heather Malenshek, SVP Marketing and Brand, 5 March 2019: “The StaCyc team shares the same vision we have for building the next generation of riders globally.”

Matt Levatich, Q1 2019 call: “kids who are enjoying two-wheeled freedom with their families, connecting through Harley Davidson dealerships and events. Starting at \$649, StaCyc products further broaden the spectrum we’ve promised in the electric two-wheel space.”

LIVEWIRE ELECTRIC MOTORCYCLES · 2025

653

\$6.1M of revenue, down 28%. \$9,342 a unit. The company sold to the public at a \$1.77B enterprise value.

STACYC · 2025

21,633

\$19.6M of revenue, up 7%. \$906 a unit. 76% of LiveWire’s product revenue, from a \$14.9M purchase.

■ UNITS, NOT PERCENTAGES • ONE GLYPH = 500 VEHICLES

LIVEWIRE
MOTORCYCLES, 2025

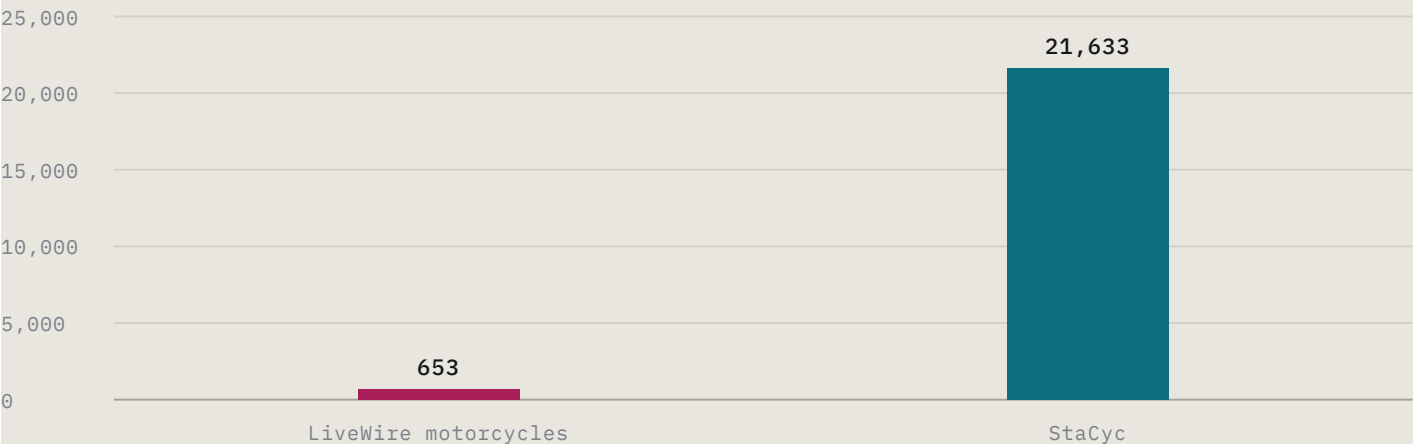
653 

STACYC, 2025

21,633



FIG 04 LIVEWIRE GROUP UNIT SALES BY PRODUCT, 2025 LIVEWIRE FY2025 RESULTS, 10 FEB 2026



DOCUMENTED Thirty-three StaCycs for every LiveWire motorcycle. Three-quarters of the product revenue of the company Harley sold to the public at \$1.77 billion comes from a \$14.9M purchase of a company that makes \$649 balance bikes for three-year-olds.

THE OLDER PRECEDENT: EAGLEMARK

In January 1993 Harley “invested \$10 million for a 49% interest in Eaglemark Financial Services,” which financed dealers’ floor plans and customers’ motorcycles. In November 1995 it bought the rest for “approximately \$45 million.” **\$55M** for the business that became HDFs, made **\$248M** of operating income in 2024, and that KKR and PIMCO paid roughly 1.75 times book for a tenth of in 2025.

THE TWO OUTSIDE PURCHASES
THAT WERE KEPT AND MADE

MONEY ARE THE TWO THAT MAKE MONEY ON SOMEBODY ELSE'S PRODUCT ON A HARLEY DEALER'S FLOOR. NEITHER HAS EVER BEEN ASKED TO BUILD A MOTORCYCLE.

■ SO WHAT • \$05

THE POINT	StaCyc is the only piece of Harley's electric decade that has ever met a volume target, and the targets it met are the ones a dealer can see from the service counter.
BACK TO THE THESIS	A family, a kid, a first purchase, a reason to come back. That is what Harley bought in 2019. The motorcycle company came with it.
OUTLOOK	If LiveWire is sold, merged or wound down, watch whether StaCyc comes back into the motor company. That is the tell.

PART I PART II PART III PART IV PART V PART VI

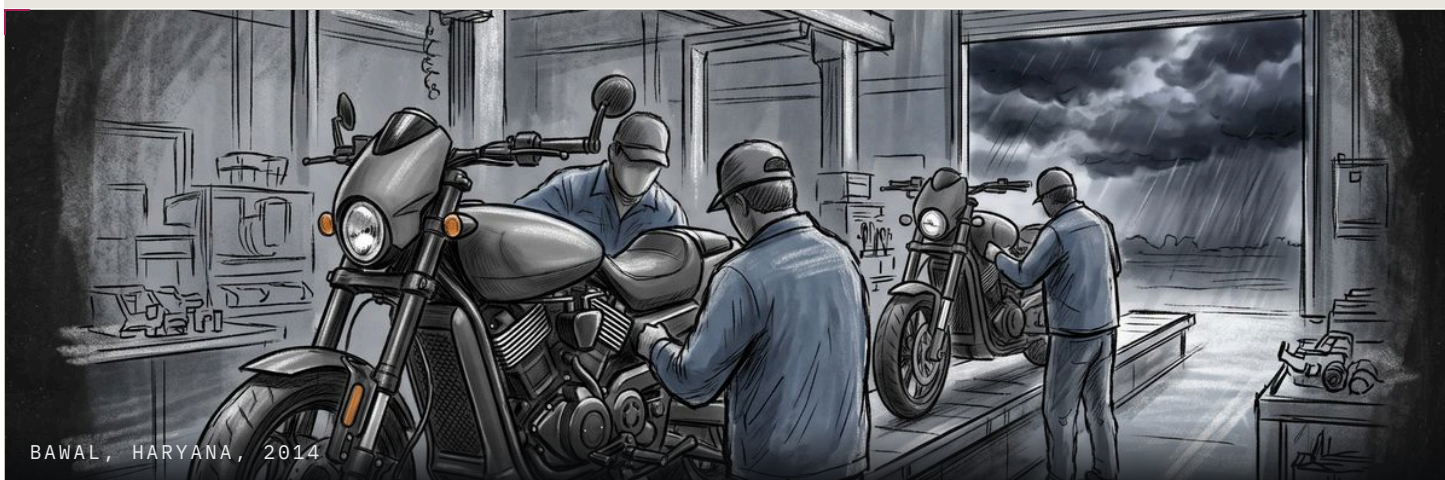
HARLEY-DAVIDSON, INC. · NYSE: HOG

PART IV

WHAT IT BUILDS

Three in-house programs, two outcomes, and the rule that falls out of them.

THE POINT	The Milwaukee-Eight and the Revolution Max got built and kept. The Street, the one time Harley built its own small bike in its own plants, lost money, closed the Indian plant, and handed the segment to Hero.
WHY IT MATTERS	Harley develops from within when the product carries the full brand at the full price. Below that line it has never once succeeded on its own, and it stopped trying in 2020.



06 • BUILT IN-HOUSE

HARLEY-DAVIDSON, INC. · NYSE: HOG

TWO ENGINES KEPT. ONE SMALL BIKE LOST MONEY AND LEFT.

The table has three things Harley built rather than bought in the last fifteen years. Two are still the engines of its highest-priced lines. The third is the reason the Sprint is a Hero.

Street 500/750, 2013. “The first all-new platform from Harley-Davidson in 13 years,” liquid-cooled Revolution X, for “young adults in cities around the world,” built in Kansas City for North America and in Bawal, India, for everywhere else. On September 24, 2020 Harley filed an 8-K “discontinuing its sales and manufacturing operations in India”: about 70 employees, “approximately **\$75 million**” of restructuring expense for the actions approved that month, of which “contract termination and other costs of approximately \$67 million.” One month later it signed the Hero agreements. The verdict came from the CFO, Gina Goetter, on the Q3 2021 call: “the decision to exit the unprofitable Street and Legacy Sportster bikes.”

Milwaukee-Eight, 2016, and Revolution Max, 2021. “The ninth Big Twin in its history” and “a clean-sheet, advanced-design effort.” Neither release gives a program cost or a development time. Both are still the engines of the two lines that carry the company. The Pan America is the one genuinely new segment Harley has

entered in twenty years by building rather than buying, and it is a \$20,000 motorcycle.

THE RULE, IN ONE SENTENCE

Harley-Davidson develops from within when the product will carry the full brand at the full price, and reaches outside for everything below it.

The one time it built its own small bike in its own plants, it lost money, closed the plant, and licensed the segment to the partner who could build the engine for ₹2.29 lakh.

INDUSTRY CONTEXT

INDUSTRY CONTEXT, NOT A FILING

York builds Touring and Softail with an IAM workforce and a cost base built for \$25,000 motorcycles. A 440 single at a York burden rate is not a \$6,000 motorcycle and everyone in the planning office knows it. That is the calculation behind “finalizing the specific production plans.” I have run it.

SO WHAT · §06

THE POINT	In-house works above the big-twin price line and has never worked below it.
BACK TO THE THESIS	Everything below the line gets bought, licensed or partnered. That is not a strategy statement; it is the record.
OUTLOOK	The 883 is the first air-cooled twin program since the Evolution and the first time since Street that Harley has tried to build below the line. Part V.

THE SPRINT RHYME

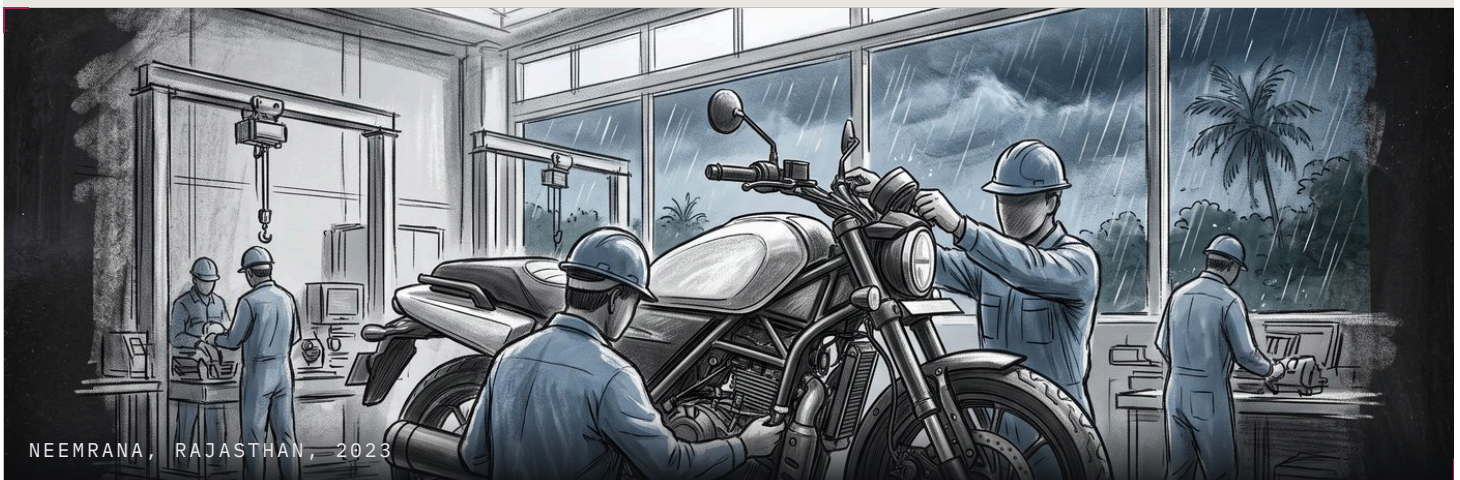
1960, an Aermacchi. 2026, a Hero. The same hole below the big twin, and somebody else's engine in it both times.

THE POINT

The first Sprint was built in Varese by a company Harley half-owned. The new one runs a 440 single Hero co-developed and builds in Neemrana for a ₹2.29 lakh motorcycle, about \$2,760. Where the Sprint is built and what it costs are undecided.

WHY IT MATTERS

Those two facts are the test of the rule. Hero-built means the rule held and the plan's "existing platforms" include a licensee's. York-built means it is not a \$6,000 motorcycle, and Street says what happens next.



07 • AERMACCHI TO HERO

HARLEY-DAVIDSON, INC. • NYSE: HOG

SAME HOLE, SOMEBODY ELSE'S ENGINE

The first Harley-Davidson Sprint was an Aermacchi. Harley bought half of the Varese motorcycle division in 1960, for about a quarter of a million dollars by the accounts that survive, because the 125cc Hummer left a gap between it and the big twins that Japan was about to fill.

It sold the Sprint for fourteen years, won three 250cc world championships (1974–76) and a 350 title with Walter Villa on Aermacchi-built Harleys, and then in 1978 AMF sold the factory and the rights to the Castiglioni brothers. Thirty years later Harley bought MV Agusta from the same family, and sold it back to them for a euro.

UNVERIFIED Prices and dates for Aermacchi are secondary-sourced; open item 3.

Sixty-six years on the Sprint returns, into the same hole, on somebody else's engine. Hero's July 3, 2023 release: the X440's 440cc single was "co-developed by Hero MotoCorp and Harley-Davidson at the Hero Center for Innovation and Technology," built at the "Garden Factory at Neemrana, Rajasthan," and priced from ₹2,29,000, about \$2,760. Trade reporting puts X440 sales at 8,974 units in the nine months to December 2024. UNVERIFIED

JUL 2025 Zeitz, Q2 call: the Sprint has "been in development since 2021," is "targeting an entry price below \$6,000," and will be "not only highly accessible, but also profitable."

NOV 2025 Starrs, Q3 call: "a bike that's lighter and easier to maneuver ... a bike that's more affordable."

MAY 2026 Starrs, Q1 call: "returning to a space that we haven't been in since the 1960s." On production: "we're finalizing the specific production plans." Trade reporting the same day: the target is now "less than \$10,000" and the build location is undecided. UNVERIFIED

JUN 2026 Hero's CEO: "If Harley finds suitability for the product in its global markets, it can take it from Hero to sell elsewhere; that decision rests with Harley." UNVERIFIED A dealer letter: order X350 RAs now, "well in advance of availability of Sprint."

JUL 2026 Starrs, Q2 call: "we expect to ship Sprint end of this year." No price, no plant, no mention of Hero.

Nobody at Harley has said where the Sprint will be built or what it will cost. Both facts are the test. If the Sprint ships from Neemrana at a Hero cost base, the rule held and the "existing platforms" in Starrs's plan include one that belongs to a

licensee in Rajasthan. If it ships from York at a York cost base, it will not be a \$6,000 motorcycle, and the Street’s history says what happens next.

■ SO WHAT • §07

THE POINT	The company has been trying to fill the space below the big twin with somebody else’s motorcycle since Eisenhower. It has never once filled it with its own.
BACK TO THE THESIS	The Sprint is a channel product for a dealer network with 554 U.S. stores and half the retail volume it had in 2014. It will be called “accessible” and never core.
OUTLOOK	The two facts that decide it, plant and MSRP, are both due before the end of 2026. Watch the Q3 call.

08 • THE 883

HARLEY-DAVIDSON, INC. · NYSE: HOG

THE OTHER HALF OF THE TEST

“Our iconic Harley-Davidson Sportster will be returning in 2027.” Air-cooled, “middleweight,” “accessible starting price point,” “the most requested motorcycle from both our riders and our dealers.”

Starrs, May 2026: “we have the cost at a place where we are comfortable against the expected MSRP.” Trade reporting: an 883cc air-cooled twin, about \$10,000, built in York. UNVERIFIED It is the first air-cooled twin program since the Evolution and, if the reporting holds, the first time in the record that the space below the big twin is being filled from Harley’s own plant, at a price where Harley has never made money. Raymond James, on the same call: “there’s a reason why Sportster was discontinued, right? It was hard to make money.”

IF THE 883 IS BUILT IN YORK AND MAKES MONEY AT ~\$10,000

IF THE SPRINT IS HERO-BUILT AND THE 883 SLIPS OR MOVES

Rule breaks

Rule holds

The plan has a second lever, and Starrs is the first CEO in the record to fill the hole from inside.

Back to the Bricks is a Touring and Softail plan with a licensee's motorcycle at the bottom, and the undecided Sprint plant was the tell.

■ SO WHAT • §08

THE POINT	Plant and price, for both bikes. Everything else about the small-bike strategy is a press release.
BACK TO THE THESIS	A Sportster built in York that makes money at \$10,000 would be the first time since 1960 that Harley filled the space below the big twin with its own motorcycle.
OUTLOOK	No. 02 carried the volume arithmetic: the 883 has to deliver most of the plan's growth on its own. The build decision is the plan.

THE FINAL WORD

Seven CEOs, one cycle, and what every purchase was actually for.

THE POINT	Each CEO's outside moves are the next CEO's focus story. LiveWire is eleven months into a CEO who did not start it, with the sentence already said and the cheapest unwind in the table.
WHY IT MATTERS	The parent never wanted the electric motorcycle. It wanted the floor traffic. Read that way, the whole record is one decision.

EACH CEO'S PURCHASES ARE THE NEXT CEO'S FOCUS STORY

Bleustein bought Buell; Wandell shut it. Ziemer bought MV; Wandell sold it. Levatich bought Alta, StaCyc, the QJ deal and the Thailand plant; Zeitz kept the two that fill dealer floors and reversed the one that built motorcycles offshore. Zeitz spun LiveWire and sold the finance company; Starrs brought Rev Max home and brought back a motorcycle discontinued four years earlier.

CEO	TENURE	BOUGHT OR STARTED	SOLD, SHUT OR REVERSED
Richard Teerlink	–1997	Eaglemark 49% and 100%; Buell 49%	Holiday Rambler
Jeffrey Bleustein	1997– 2005	Buell to ~100%	none
James Ziemer	2005– 2009	MV Agusta	none
Keith Wandell	2009– 2015	none	Buell; MV Agusta
Matt Levatich	2015– 2020	Thailand plant; Alta; StaCyc; Qianjiang; Silicon Valley R&D; LiveWire as a brand	Alta
Jochen Zeitz	2020– 2025	Hero licence; LiveWire SPAC; KYMCO; HDFS to KKR/PIMCO	India manufacturing; Street; Sportster; Bronx; Rev Max to Thailand
Artie Starrs	Oct 2025–	Sprint; Sportster 883 return; Dust (via LiveWire)	Rev Max back from Thailand; “leaned heavily into Touring and Electric”

Buell lasted sixteen years under Harley ownership and eleven months into a new CEO. MV lasted fourteen months into one. LiveWire is eleven months into Starrs. That is not a strategy; it is a cycle, and the table is its record.

■ SO WHAT · §09

THE POINT	Seven CEOs, and the outside moves reset every five to seven years, with the same sentence.
BACK TO THE THESIS	What survives the reset is whatever makes money on somebody else’s product on a dealer’s floor: HDFS, StaCyc, the licences.
OUTLOOK	The next reset is LiveWire’s, and it has a date: cash to about May 2027, the \$75M note due December 15, 2027.

10 · ANALYSIS, NOT REPORTING

HARLEY-DAVIDSON, INC. · NYSE: HOG

WHAT IT WAS FOR

Everything above this line is filed. This section is judgment, and says so.

INFERRED

LIVEWIRE

It is following the Buell and MV Agusta script, and the script has four lines. A CEO who did not start it. The focus sentence, already written: “Over the last several years, we leaned heavily into Touring and Electric. Going forward, we are shifting to a more rider-centric portfolio.” A cheap unwind: the public minority is roughly \$28M at recent prices, the assets are pledged to Harley under the \$75M secured note, and Harley “does not plan to make additional investments” (No. 02 §3). And a date: cash to about May 2027, the note due December 15, 2027. Buell cost \$125M to shut. MV cost \$268M. LiveWire’s losses are already consolidated; the unwind costs Harley a write-down on a note it holds against collateral it built. It is the cheapest exit in the table.

INFERRED

STACYC AND DUST

The two pieces of LiveWire with a future are the two that were never electric motorcycles. StaCyc is a dealer-traffic product with a margin and a five-year record of hitting volume targets. Dust is an option on off-road electric that cost \$375,000 in cash and \$3.5M all-in before earn-outs. It is the Alta structure, done inside a subsidiary this time, so the write-off, if it comes, lands in a segment Harley has already told investors to look past. If LiveWire is sold, merged or wound down, watch whether these two are carved back into the motor company. That would be the tell.

INDUSTRY CONTEXT

THE SPRINT

Hero-built or Hero-engined; a channel product for a dealer network with 554 U.S. stores and half the retail it had in 2014; described as “accessible” and never as core; kept as long as it does not carry a Harley badge into a Harley segment. Volume will matter more than margin because the margin is Hero’s.

INDUSTRY CONTEXT

THE 883

The one that decides whether Starrs is different. Build location and MSRP are the two facts that matter; both were open items in No. 02 and both are still open.

INFERRED

THE FINAL WORD • HARLEY-DAVIDSON

HARLEY DOESN'T WANT ELECTRIC. IT WANTS FLOOR TRAFFIC.

The Milwaukee-Eight and the Revolution Max got built because a Touring bike and a Pan America carry a \$25,000 price that pays for an engine program. A 440 single, a balance bike, a battery and a consumer loan book do not, and every one of them was bought, licensed or partnered. Kept when it feeds the dealer. Dropped when it competes with the badge.

Read the electric decade that way and it stops looking like a series of mistakes. Alta was a battery lesson bought for a sum too small to disclose. LiveWire was an option on a category, sold to the public so the losses would sit somewhere else until consolidation brought them home. StaCyc was the only part of it Harley ever wanted for its own sake: a **\$649** product that puts a family on a dealer floor and brings them back in ten years for a Sportster. **It is the one part of the electric decade the company has never had to write down, and it is the one that was never an electric motorcycle.**

I ran product at Harley. I know the meeting where a program gets its cost target, and I know which programs never get one because the answer is already known. The Sprint got one in 2021 and is still “finalizing production plans” in 2026. That is the answer.

Ground Truth No. 02 ended by asking which brick LiveWire is under. This one ends with the question underneath that. **The record says Harley keeps what fills the dealer floor and sells what competes with the badge. Which of those is the Sprint?**

11 • SOURCES

EVERY DOCUMENT, LINKED

Each row in the first table opens the filing on EDGAR. The second is company releases and full call transcripts. The third is secondary, and nothing rests on it that is not marked Unverified in the text.

DOCUMENT	FILED	WHAT IT SUPPORTS	LINK
Form 10-K, FY1994 Harley-Davidson, Inc.	Mar 1995	Eaglemark \$10M for 49%; Buell 49%; Holiday Rambler acquired Dec 1986	Open on EDGAR → 0000950131-95-000813
Form 10-K, FY1996 Harley-Davidson, Inc.	Mar 1997	Eaglemark remainder ~\$45M (Nov 1995); Transportation Vehicles segment sold ~\$105M, gain \$22.6M, “core motorcycle business”	Open on EDGAR → 0000912057-97-011157
8-K, MV Agusta announcement Harley-Davidson, Inc.	11 Jul 2008	~€70M (\$109M) incl. ~€45M of bank debt; contingent payment 2016; Ziemer quote	Open on EDGAR → 0000897069-08-001146
Form 10-Q, Q3 2008 Harley-Davidson, Inc.	30 Oct 2008	MV closing 8 Aug 2008; €68.3M (\$105.1M); initial goodwill \$87.9M, IPR&D \$16.6M	Open on EDGAR → 0001193125-08-220204
8-K Ex. 99.1, Q3 2009 results Harley-Davidson, Inc.	15 Oct 2009	Buell discontinuation, ~\$125M; MV divestiture; Wandell “focus” sentences; Q3 impairments \$14.2M / \$18.9M	Open on EDGAR → 0001193125-09-208172
Form 10-Q, Q3 2009 · Note 19 Harley-Davidson, Inc.	30 Oct 2009	Buell exit cost by category; MV goodwill \$85.6M; earn-out terms	Open on EDGAR → 0001193125-09-218615
Form 10-K, FY2009 · MV note Harley-Davidson, Inc.	23 Feb 2010	Final allocation; goodwill \$85.75M; IPR&D \$20.1M; 2009 impairment \$115.4M; discontinued ops 2008–09	Open on EDGAR → 0001193125-10-037160
8-K, MV sale · Ex. 2.1 Sale and Purchase Agreement Harley-Davidson, Inc.	9 Aug 2010	€1 / \$1 / €1; €20.0M capital increase; earn-out waived; prior write-downs \$162.6M net	Open on EDGAR → 0001193125-10-183610
Form 10-K, FY2010 · discontinued	24 Feb 2011	2010 impairment \$111.8M; “nominal consideration”; loss table 2008–10; Buell production ceased Oct 2009	Open on EDGAR → 0001193125-11-045258

DOCUMENT	FILED	WHAT IT SUPPORTS	LINK
operations Harley-Davidson, Inc.			
8-K Ex. 99.1, Q4 2011 results Harley-Davidson, Inc.	24 Jan 2012	\$51.0M benefit on discontinued operations; IRS agreement; “no further financial adjustments related to MV Agusta”	Open on EDGAR → 0001193125-12-021080
Form 10-K, FY2014 Harley-Davidson, Inc.	Feb 2015	694 U.S. dealerships; 2014 retail	Open on EDGAR → 0000793952-15-000009
8-K Ex. 99.1, Q1 2018 results Harley-Davidson, Inc.	24 Apr 2018	The only “Alta” sentence in any H-D filing	Open on EDGAR → 0000793952-18-000017
8-K Ex. 99.1, More Roads Harley-Davidson, Inc.	30 Jul 2018	LiveWire 2019; models through 2022; \$450–550M opex, \$225–275M capex; Asia small-displacement alliance	Open on EDGAR → 0000793952-18-000046
Form 10-Q, Q3 2018 Harley-Davidson, Inc.	8 Nov 2018	Investment (loss) income –\$1,106K; no Alta, no equity-investment note	Open on EDGAR → 0000793952-18-000057
Form D / D/A chain Faster Faster, Inc. (Alta Motors)	2016–2018	Five Reg D notices; round closed \$20,843,998 (D/A, 5 Feb 2018); \$5.0M bridge (13 Aug 2018)	Open on EDGAR → 0001620298-18-000001 · -18-000002
Form 10-Q, Q1 2019 · goodwill note Harley-Davidson, Inc.	9 May 2019	StaCyc: \$14.9M total; \$7.0M cash; goodwill \$9.5M; intangibles \$5.3M	Open on EDGAR → 0000793952-19-000021
Form 10-K, FY2019 · R80–R82 Harley-Davidson, Inc.	19 Feb 2020	StaCyc XBRL details; goodwill roll-forward +\$9,520K	Open on EDGAR → 0000793952-20-000008
8-K, India exit Harley-Davidson, Inc.	24 Sep 2020	Discontinuing India sales and manufacturing; ~70 employees; ~\$75M; \$67M contract termination	Open on EDGAR → 0000793952-20-000097

DOCUMENT	FILED	WHAT IT SUPPORTS	LINK
8-K Ex. 99.1, LiveWire / ABIC Harley-Davidson, Inc.	13 Dec 2021	\$1.77B EV; H-D \$100M; KYMCO \$100M; StaCyc included in LiveWire	Open on EDGAR → 0001193125-21-354631
8-K Ex. 99.1, carve-out financial statements LiveWire Group, Inc.	30 Sep 2022	StaCyc earn-out: \$4,978K fair value; \$0–\$6,537K; \$2,180K paid 2020, 2021, 2022	Open on EDGAR → 0001193125-22-255710
Form 10-K, FY2022 · R71 LiveWire Group, Inc.	6 Mar 2023	Contingent consideration roll-forward; goodwill \$8,327K	Open on EDGAR → 0001898795-23-000023
8-K, Dust Motorcycles APA and KYMCO agreement LiveWire Group, Inc.	22 May 2026	\$375K cash; \$500K stock; 3 × \$875K stock; earn-outs to \$11.25M; KYMCO five-year exclusivity	Open on EDGAR → 0001193125-26-237206
8-K Ex. 99.1, Q2 2026 results LiveWire Group, Inc.	23 Jul 2026	267 motorcycles; 5,223 StaCyc; Honcho production; Dust closed	Open on EDGAR → 0001898795-26-000064
Form 10-K, FY2025 Harley-Davidson, Inc.	26 Feb 2026	554 U.S. dealerships; HDFS 9.8% to KKR/PIMCO; Thailand	Open on EDGAR → 0000793952-26-000011

RELEASES AND TRANSCRIPTS

DOCUMENT	DATE	LINK
H-D release · Alta investment	1 Mar 2018	Open →
H-D release · Silicon Valley R&D facility	5 Sep 2018	Open →
H-D release · StaCyc acquisition	5 Mar 2019	Open →
H-D release · Qianjiang	19 Jun 2019	Open →
H-D release · Hero MotoCorp agreements	27 Oct 2020	Open →
H-D release · MV Agusta sale	6 Aug 2010	Open →
H-D release · Street platform	4 Nov 2013	Open →
H-D release · Milwaukee-Eight	23 Aug 2016	Open →
H-D Media Kit · Revolution Max 1250	22 Feb 2021	Open →
H-D release · KKR / PIMCO	30 Jul 2025	Open →
H-D release · Rev Max returns to U.S.	9 Jun 2026	Open →
Hero MotoCorp release · X440	3 Jul 2023	Open →
LiveWire release · FY2025 results	10 Feb 2026	Open →
LiveWire release · Dust Moto	19 May 2026	Open →
LiveWire release · S4 Honcho production	8 Jun 2026	Open →
BRP release · Alta assets	20 Feb 2019	Open →
Transcript · Q1 2019 call (Levatich on StaCyc)	23 Apr 2019	Open →
Transcript · Q3 2021 call (Goetter on Street)	27 Oct 2021	Open →

DOCUMENT	DATE	LINK
Transcript · Q2 2025 call (Zeitz on Sprint)	30 Jul 2025	Open →
Transcript · Q1 2026 call (Starrs)	5 May 2026	Open →
Transcript · Q2 2026 call (Starrs)	23 Jul 2026	Open →

SECONDARY, USED ONLY WHERE FLAGGED

SOURCE	DATE	LINK
Asphalt & Rubber · Alta break-up (sourced report)	29 Aug 2018	Open →
TechCrunch · Alta closure; H-D statement	18 Oct 2018	Open →
RideApart · Fenigstein interview	2024	Open →
Motorcycle.com · Sprint price and plant (deck paraphrase)	5 May 2026	Open →
Motorcycle.com · Sportster 883 (deck paraphrase)	5 May 2026	Open →
Autocar Professional · X440 volumes	30 Jan 2025	Open →
motorcycles.news · Hero CEO on Sprint	23 Jun 2026	Open →
Powersports Business · dealer letter, X350 RA and Sprint	25 Jun 2026	Open →
Roadracing World · Buell statement, 135,000 units	15 Oct 2009	Open →
Powersports Business · Erik Buell	14 Mar 2011	Open →
Deseret News / AP · Holiday Rambler sale	26 Jan 1996	Open →
Family RVing · Holiday Rambler \$155M	Oct 2003	Open →
Curbside Classic; Classic Bike Hub; Motorcycle Classics; Rider · Aermacchi	various	Open →

WHO WROTE THIS, AND HOW



WILLIAM WEPPNER
CONTACT PATCH ADVISORY

I'm an independent expert witness and litigation consultant. EV and powersports product liability. Contact Patch Advisory is the practice.

I spent most of my career inside the companies this brief is about. At **Harley-Davidson** I ran product for Touring, CVO and Trike, the lines that pay for everything else on Juneau Avenue. Before that, sales planning lead for the CRF range at **Honda** and planning lead on the Grom, the bike that still defines the segment the Sprint is walking into. Later, product development at **Super73**, OEM sales at **Sena**, and **Faction MX**, which I founded and sold.

I race motocross at expert level and I ride constantly. It matters here for one reason: when this brief says what a bike costs to build, what a dealer can retail in a season, or how much a segment will absorb, those are calls I made for a living, not things I pulled from a spreadsheet.

Nobody else is doing this particular job. The analysts don't read manufacturing agreements. The powersports people don't read 10-Ks. I do both, and the gap between what these companies announce and what they file is where the story usually is.

PRACTICE	Independent expert witness & litigation consultant, EV and powersports product liability
HARLEY-DAVIDSON	Product Manager: Touring, CVO, Trike
HONDA	Sales Planning Lead, CRF line; planning lead, Grom
SUPER73	Director of Product Development
SENA TECHNOLOGIES	Director of OEM Sales
FACTION MX	Founder; sold to private equity
ALSO	Amphenol Nova Sensor · LID Technology · expert-level motocross racer



Left: the Low Rider on the freeway. Middle: leading a group through the canyons. Right: the day job on weekends.

STANDING AND INDEPENDENCE

I hold no position in Harley-Davidson, LiveWire Group, Hero MotoCorp, KYMCO, or any company named here: long, short, or derivative. I have no engagement, adverse or friendly, with any of them. I know Marc Fenigstein, Alta's co-founder, and have worked with him since Alta closed; his account quoted in §04 is public record and is identified as his.

Where a conclusion rests on my time in the industry rather than a document, I say so.

Where an earlier version of this was wrong, the fix is in the log at §13, not made quietly. If something here is wrong, tell me.

METHOD

Primary documents first. Every dollar figure on MV Agusta, Buell, StaCyc, Eaglemark, India, Dust and LiveWire is from a filing, linked in §11. Alta's bound is from Alta's own Form D chain, and is marked as an inference.

Derived figures are labelled. Loss-to-consideration multiples, loss per month, units per unit, revenue per unit and the Form D increment are arithmetic on filed numbers; the script is in the repo at `tools/gt03/calc.py`.

Fact and opinion are separated. §§01–09 are sourced. §10 is judgment and says so. Where a reading rests on my time in the industry (the York cost base, the planning-office calculation) it is tagged Industry context.

No inside sources. Nothing here rests on anything I was told. The public record carries every claim.

EVIDENCE STATUS

Major findings carry one of five tags, so a reader can see at a glance what kind of claim is being made and how to attack it.

DOCUMENTED

Stated in a filing, contract, release or transcript, and linked to it.

CALCULATED

Arithmetic on documented numbers, with the computation shown.

INFERRED

A conclusion supported by more than one documented fact, but stated by none of them.

INDUSTRY CONTEXT

My professional experience or established industry practice, not a document.

UNVERIFIED

Plausible, and not independently establishable from public information.

WHAT IS NOT YET NAILED DOWN, AND WHAT REV. O GOT WRONG

Ten open items. Anything in this list is tagged Unverified where it appears above.
The corrections log is public policy: nothing is fixed silently.

#	ITEM	STATUS
1	Alta investment amount	Not in any H-D filing (full-text search, 2018–2019). The bound in §04 is inferred from Faster Faster, Inc.’s Form D chain. The FY2018 10-K MD&A paragraph on investment income was not retrieved. It is the one place an unnamed write-off might be described.
2	“Alta Motors” in LiveWire’s 10-Ks	LiveWire’s FY2024 and FY2025 10-Ks contain the string (EDGAR full-text hit); location not retrieved, probably an officer biography.
3	Aermacchi	1960 price (~\$250K), 1978 sale price, Sprint volumes and the year of full ownership (1972–74) are secondary only.
4	Holiday Rambler purchase price	\$155M is trade press (Family RVing, 2003); the 1986 annual report is not on EDGAR.
5	Buell 1993 price and cumulative units	~\$500K and 135,000+ / 136,923 are secondary.
6	Hero X440 volumes; Sprint build source	8,974 (Apr–Dec 2024) is Autocar Professional’s. Neither Harley nor Hero has confirmed Hero builds the Sprint. Check the dealer-meeting materials and the Q3 call.
7	Sprint price; 883 price and plant	“Less than \$10,000” and “~\$10,000 / York” are press paraphrases of the 5 May 2026 investor deck. Fetch the deck.
8	Milwaukee-Eight and Rev Max program costs	Not in either release; check capex commentary 2014–2020.
9	LiveWire TTM units	923 to June 2026 is from No. 01; the Q1 2026 release was not re-pulled.
10	Realized India exit charge	\$75M is the estimate for actions approved September 2020; FY2020 restructuring was \$130.0M for all 2020 actions and does not break India out.

CORRECTIONS LOG

Rev. 0 (8 September 2026) was an outline built from secondary sources. Rev. 1 (9 September 2026) corrects it on reading the filings.

WHAT WAS CLAIMED

WHAT THE DOCUMENT SAID

MV Agusta: “~\$163M of losses in 24 months.”

That is the 8-K’s “prior write-downs of \$162.6 million, net of tax,” which is impairments only. The filed net loss from discontinued operations is **\$268.4M** (2008–10), \$217.4M after the Q4 2011 tax reversal.

MV sale: “€1 with €20M of H-D cash inside.”

Right but incomplete: three nominal payments (€1 shares, \$1 U.S. LLC, €1 for a €103.8M receivable), €20.0M into escrow, earn-out waived.

StaCyc 2025 units: 21,141.

21,633 (LiveWire FY2025 release). Ratio to motorcycles 32 → 33.

HDFS: “9.8% to KKR/PIMCO, ~\$6B book sold.”

4.9% each to KKR and PIMCO (9.8% collectively, FY2025 10-K) and “over \$5 billion” of receivables (30 Jul 2025 release).

Thailand plant, 2018.

Announced 25 May 2017; producing 2018.

“Zeitz, 2025: unprofitable” on Street.

The on-the-record statement is CFO Gina Goetter’s, Q3 2021 call. Zeitz said “prune unprofitable motorcycles” without naming Street.

Buell exit cost \$125M, stated as fact.

It is the October 2009 estimate (Q3 2009 10-Q, Note 19). No filing reports a realized Buell-only total.

Holiday Rambler sold 1996 for ~\$50M.

The whole Transportation Vehicles segment went for ~\$105M, gain \$22.6M (FY1996 10-K); ~\$50M was the RV division per wire reports.

Alta: H-D “would instead build its own R&D center in Silicon Valley.”

Paraphrase. The facility was announced in a separate release, 5 Sep 2018.

Dust: cost undisclosed.

Terms are in LiveWire’s 22 May 2026 8-K.

S4 Honcho \$4,999.

\$4,999 Trail; \$5,499 Street.

Aermacchi full ownership 1974.

Sources split 1972/1973/1974; stated as “early 1970s.”

WHAT THIS BRIEF DOES AND DOES NOT CLAIM

Every figure is drawn from SEC filings, company releases, or full call transcripts, except where marked Unverified. Derived figures (loss multiples, per-unit revenue, the Form D increment) are arithmetic on filed numbers and are identified as such in the captions.

This brief does not assert, and no filing states, that Harley-Davidson intends to sell, wind down, reabsorb or otherwise change its relationship with LiveWire, StaCyc or Dust, or that the Sprint will be built by Hero MotoCorp. §10 is an enumeration of what the record has done before, identified as judgment. The Alta investment amount has never been disclosed by Harley-Davidson; the bound in §04 is an inference from Faster Faster, Inc.'s Regulation D notices and is labelled as such.

Marc Fenigstein's account of the Alta-Harley collaboration is quoted from a published interview, is his, and is unverified. The author knows him and has worked with him. That relationship is disclosed in §12 and here.

Prior issues: No. 02, Harley-Davidson: Back to the Bricks · No. 01, LiveWire: 5 Years In and 1% of Plan · Index

CONTACT PATCH ADVISORY · GROUND TRUTH NO. 03 · REV. 1 · WILLIAM WEPPNER · SEPTEMBER 2026